

30 Quick & Healthy Meals

Eat Well, Spend Less, Feel Great

Table of Contents

1. Introduction: The \$10 Promise
2. Smart Shopping Tips
3. Kitchen Essentials
4. Energizing Breakfasts
5. Power Lunches
6. Satisfying Dinners
7. Budget Swaps & Substitutions

INTRODUCTION: THE \$10 PROMISE

Welcome to the first edition of **Daily Dollar Ebooks**! You shouldn't have to choose between your health and your wallet. This book is designed to give you 30 delicious, nutritious recipes that cost less than \$10 to make for a family of 2-4, or even less per serving if you're cooking for one.

Every recipe in this book uses simple, easy-to-find ingredients and takes 30 minutes or less of active prep time. Let's get cooking!

SMART SHOPPING TIPS

- **Buy Bulk:** Grains like rice, quinoa, and oats are much cheaper in bulk bins.
- **Frozen is Fine:** Frozen fruits and vegetables are just as nutritious as fresh and often half the price.
- **Generic Brands:** Most store brands are identical to name brands but 30% cheaper.
- **Seasonal Produce:** Buy what's in season for the best price and flavor.
- **Plant-Based Proteins:** Beans, lentils, and eggs are the ultimate budget-friendly proteins.

KITCHEN ESSENTIALS

Before we start, make sure you have these basics in your pantry:

- Olive oil or vegetable oil
- Salt and black pepper
- Garlic powder and onion powder
- Dried oregano and cumin
- Soy sauce or balsamic vinegar

ENERGIZING BREAKFASTS

1. Peanut Butter & Banana Overnight Oats

🕒 5 MINS 💰 ~\$1.50

Ingredients:

1/2 cup rolled oats, 1/2 cup milk (any kind), 1 tbsp peanut butter, 1/2 banana sliced.

Instructions:

Mix oats, milk, and peanut butter in a jar. Top with banana. Refrigerate overnight.

Budget Tip: Buy the large tub of oats, not the individual packets.

2. Spinach & Feta Scramble

🕒 10 MINS 💰 ~\$3.00

Ingredients:

2 eggs, handful of fresh spinach, 1 tbsp feta cheese, salt/pepper.

Instructions:

Whisk eggs. Sauté spinach in a pan until wilted. Add eggs and scramble. Top with feta.

3. Two-Ingredient Banana Pancakes

🕒 10 MINS 💰 ~\$1.00

Ingredients:

1 ripe banana, 2 eggs.

Instructions:

Mash banana until smooth. Whisk in eggs. Cook small spoonfuls on a greased skillet over medium heat.

4. Greek Yogurt & Berry Parfait

🕒 5 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00

Ingredients:

1 cup Greek yogurt, 1/4 cup frozen berries (thawed), 2 tbsp granola.

Instructions:

Layer yogurt and berries in a glass. Top with granola.

5. Budget Breakfast Burritos

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00 (MAKES 4)

Ingredients:

4 tortillas, 4 eggs (scrambled), 1/2 cup canned black beans, 1/2 cup shredded cheese.

Instructions:

Fill tortillas with eggs, beans, and cheese. Roll up and sear in a pan for 1 minute per side.

6. Avocado Toast with Everything Seasoning

🕒 5 MINS 💰 ~\$2.50

Ingredients:

1 slice whole-grain bread (toasted), 1/2 small avocado, pinch of salt or "Everything Bagel" seasoning.

Instructions:

Mash avocado on toast. Sprinkle with seasoning.

7. Coconut Chia Pudding

🕒 5 MINS + SOAK 💰 ~\$3.00

Ingredients:

2 tbsp chia seeds, 1/2 cup coconut milk (canned or carton), 1 tsp honey or maple syrup.

Instructions:

Stir ingredients together. Let sit in fridge for at least 2 hours or overnight.

POWER LUNCHES

8. Tuna & Chickpea Salad Wraps

🕒 10 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00

Ingredients:

1 can tuna, 1/2 can chickpeas (rinsed), 1 tbsp mayo or Greek yogurt, 2 large tortillas or lettuce leaves.

Instructions:

Mix tuna, chickpeas, and mayo. Season with pepper. Wrap in tortillas.

9. Mediterranean Mason Jar Salad

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$6.00 (MAKES 2)

Ingredients:

2 tbsp vinaigrette, 1/2 cup chickpeas, 1/2 cup chopped cucumbers, 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes, 2 cups spinach.

Instructions:

Layer in jar: Dressing (bottom), chickpeas, cucumbers, tomatoes, then spinach (top). Shake before eating.

10. Quinoa & Black Bean Bowl

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00

Ingredients:

1/2 cup cooked quinoa, 1/2 cup black beans, 1/4 cup corn (frozen or canned), salsa.

Instructions:

Combine ingredients in a bowl. Serve cold or warm.

11. Classic Egg Salad Sandwiches

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$2.00

Ingredients:

2 hard-boiled eggs (chopped), 1 tbsp mayo, 1/2 tsp mustard, 2 slices bread.

Instructions:

Mix eggs, mayo, and mustard. Spread on bread.

12. Turkey & Hummus Roll-Ups

🕒 5 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00

Ingredients:

4 slices deli turkey, 4 tbsp hummus, 1/2 bell pepper (sliced thin).

Instructions:

Spread hummus on turkey slices. Add pepper strips and roll up.

13. Sweet Potato & Black Bean Quesadilla

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$3.50

Ingredients:

1 small sweet potato (mashed), 1/4 cup black beans, 1/4 cup cheese, 2 tortillas.

Instructions:

Spread potato and beans on one tortilla. Add cheese. Top with second tortilla and cook in a pan until cheese melts.

14. Quick Red Lentil Soup

🕒 25 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00 (SERVES 4)

Ingredients:

1 cup red lentils, 1 can diced tomatoes, 1 tsp cumin, 3 cups water.

Instructions:

Simmer all ingredients in a pot for 20 minutes until lentils are soft.

15. Pesto Pasta Salad

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00

Ingredients:

2 cups cooked pasta, 2 tbsp store-bought pesto, 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes (halved).

Instructions:

Toss all ingredients together. Great cold!

16. Hummus & Veggie Snack Plate

🕒 5 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00

Ingredients:

1/2 cup hummus, 1 carrot (sliced), 1/2 cucumber (sliced), a few pita crackers.

Instructions:

Arrange on a plate and dip.

17. Spicy Peanut Noodles

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$3.00

Ingredients:

1 serving spaghetti or ramen noodles, 1 tbsp peanut butter, 1 tsp soy sauce, 1 tsp sriracha.

Instructions:

Cook noodles. Mix PB, soy sauce, and sriracha with a splash of hot noodle water. Toss with noodles.

SATISFYING DINNERS

18. Sheet Pan Chicken & Broccoli

🕒 30 MINS 💰 ~\$8.00

Ingredients:

1 lb chicken thighs, 2 cups broccoli florets, 1 tbsp olive oil, 1 tsp garlic powder.

Instructions:

Toss everything on a baking sheet. Bake at 400°F (200°C) for 20-25 minutes.

19. One-Pot Tomato & Basil Pasta

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$4.50

Ingredients:

8oz pasta, 1 can diced tomatoes, 2 cloves garlic (minced), 2 cups water, fresh or dried basil.

Instructions:

Put all ingredients in a large pot. Bring to a boil and simmer until water is absorbed and pasta is cooked (about 10 mins).

20. Veggie Stir-Fry with Tofu

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$6.00

Ingredients:

1 block firm tofu (cubed), 2 cups frozen stir-fry veggies, 2 tbsp soy sauce.

Instructions:

Sear tofu in a pan until golden. Add veggies and soy sauce. Sauté until tender.

21. Lentil Walnut Tacos

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00

Ingredients:

1 can lentils (drained), 1/2 cup crushed walnuts, 1 tbsp taco seasoning, small tortillas.

Instructions:

Sauté lentils and walnuts with seasoning for 5 mins. Serve in tortillas with your favorite toppings.

22. Ground Turkey Stuffed Peppers

🕒 35 MINS 💰 ~\$9.00

Ingredients:

1/2 lb ground turkey, 1/2 cup cooked rice, 2 bell peppers (halved), 1/2 cup salsa.

Instructions:

Mix turkey, rice, and salsa. Stuff into peppers. Bake at 375°F (190°C) for 25-30 mins.

23. Crispy Salmon Cakes

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$6.00

Ingredients:

1 can salmon (drained), 1 egg, 1/4 cup breadcrumbs, green onions.

Instructions:

Mix ingredients, form into patties, and pan-fry for 4 mins per side.

24. Black Bean & Corn Burgers

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$4.00 (MAKES 4)

Ingredients:

1 can black beans (mashed), 1/2 cup corn, 1/2 cup breadcrumbs, 1 tsp cumin.

Instructions:

Mix ingredients, form patties, and bake or pan-fry until firm.

25. Cauliflower Fried Rice

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00

Ingredients:

1 bag frozen cauliflower rice, 1/2 cup frozen peas/carrots, 1 egg, 1 tbsp soy sauce.

Instructions:

Sauté cauliflower and veggies. Move to side, scramble egg in pan, then mix everything with soy sauce.

26. Beef & Cabbage Skillet

🕒 20 MINS 💰 ~\$8.00

Ingredients:

1/2 lb ground beef, 1/2 head cabbage (shredded), 1 tbsp soy sauce, ginger powder.

Instructions:

Brown beef. Add cabbage and seasonings. Sauté until cabbage is tender.

27. Spinach & Ricotta Stuffed Shells

🕒 35 MINS 💰 ~\$7.00

Ingredients:

12 jumbo pasta shells (cooked), 1 cup ricotta, 1 cup frozen spinach (thawed/squeezed), 1 cup marinara sauce.

Instructions:

Mix ricotta and spinach. Fill shells. Top with sauce and bake at 350°F (175°C) for 20 mins.

28. Simple Veggie Chili

🕒 30 MINS 💰 ~\$6.00

Ingredients:

1 can black beans, 1 can kidney beans, 1 can diced tomatoes, 1 tbsp chili powder.

Instructions:

Simmer all ingredients in a pot for 20 mins.

29. Garlic Herb Roasted Chicken Thighs

🕒 35 MINS 💰 ~\$7.00

Ingredients:

1 lb chicken thighs, 2 potatoes (cubed), 1 tsp dried rosemary, garlic powder.

Instructions:

Toss thighs and potatoes with oil and spices. Bake at 400°F (200°C) for 30 mins.

30. Zucchini Noodles with Marinara

🕒 15 MINS 💰 ~\$5.00

Ingredients:

2 large zucchinis (spiralized or peeled into ribbons), 1 cup marinara sauce, optional parmesan.

Instructions:

Sauté zucchini ribbons for 2-3 mins (don't overcook!). Top with warmed marinara.

BUDGET SWAPS & SUBSTITUTIONS

Don't have an ingredient? Don't stress.

- **No Quinoa?** Use rice or couscous.
- **No Fresh Spinach?** Use frozen or kale.
- **No Chicken Thighs?** Ground turkey or tofu are great swaps.
- **No Feta?** Use goat cheese or just omit—the eggs are still great!

Conclusion

Eating healthy doesn't have to be expensive or complicated. By focusing on whole ingredients and cooking at home, you can save hundreds of dollars a month while feeling your best.

We hope these 30 recipes become staples in your kitchen. Stay tuned for more Daily Dollar Ebooks!

Got a suggestion for our next book? Let us know!